Frosthaven Mods

Mod guide · version 0.9.4 · what each mod does and how to use it

> **The short version:** everyone installs the same version of the mods. The host turns on the mods the group wants in **Options > Custom Rules**. Everything else happens in the game as usual.

Installing and updating

1. Close Frosthaven.
2. Download **Install Frosthaven Mods.exe** from the latest release: github.com/Kalarian/Frosthaven-Mods/releases/latest
3. Run it and click **Install / Update**. If Windows warns you, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
4. The installer always fetches the newest version, so you can keep the same file and run it again for updates.

Everyone in a co-op game must have the same version. The game won't stop you from joining with a different one; instead, things go out of sync partway through a scenario. If you're not sure, everyone runs the installer before you play.

To remove the mods, run the installer and click **Remove mods**. Your saves are never changed, and a campaign played with the mods still loads without them. The one exception is a campaign that has used a Gloomhaven class (see **Content packs**): it needs the mods for good.

Turning mods on and off

- Every mod is a switch in **Options > Custom Rules** while a campaign is loaded. All of them start off.
- The **host** decides. The switches are saved with the campaign and sent to everyone who joins.
- You can change them at any time in the outpost. Mods that change how scenarios play can't be changed during an online scenario (the switch says so); change them back in the outpost.

MOD	IN ONE LINE	CHANGES THE GAME?
Tradeable resources and equipment	Give gold, materials and items to another character	Yes
Share duplicate loot	A second copy of an item you loot goes to someone else instead of being sold	Yes
Easier item reward window	Handing out item rewards takes fewer clicks	No
Reveal event outcomes	See what each event choice will do before you pick it	Yes (information)
Show personal quest rewards	Quest cards show the building each quest unlocks when you retire	No
Reduced randomness	No nulls or x2s in modifier decks: a -2 and a +2 instead	Yes
Masteries carry over	A mastery earned once counts for every later character of that class	Yes
Dwarf's balance changes	A few fixes to the campaign's rough spots, from a well-known player	Yes
More story events	Town events that unlock something come up more often	Yes

Game bug fixes	Fixes bugs in the game itself	Yes (bug fixes)
Milestone saves	Automatic backup saves you can go back to	No
Battle stats	Lots more stats after each scenario, and campaign totals	No
Modifier deck odds	Shows the odds of your next attack modifier draw	No
Scenario map file	Saves your progress for the scenario map page	No
Gloomhaven classes: all open at once	With the Gloomhaven classes pack: every class open at once instead of one per retirement	No

The mods

Tradeable resources and equipment changes the game

Pass gold, lumber, metal, hide and items between characters in the party. Normally each character keeps their own.

HOW TO USE

- In the outpost, hold Ctrl and click the portrait of one of *your* characters in the party column on the left, or click the **GIVE** button under their name at the top.
- **Resources** tab: each column is another party member. Click a cell to give 1, right-click to take 1 back, Ctrl+click for 10, Shift+click for everything (or nothing).
- **Items** tab: click the cell under the person who should get the item.
- Nothing happens until you press **Give**. Esc closes the window without giving.

GOOD TO KNOW

- Herbs aren't in it: the game already keeps herbs in one shared supply.
- Nobody can own two copies of the same item, so someone who already has it can't be picked.
- Gold and materials can also go to a character being created. Items go to party members only.

Share duplicate loot changes the game

When you loot an item you already own, the game normally sells it on the spot. With this on, the party decides who gets it, which is the board game's rule.

HOW TO USE

- Nothing to do during the scenario. Back in the outpost, the usual item reward window opens: pick who gets it.
- If nobody else in the party can take it, it's sold as usual. To sell it anyway, the new owner sells it in the shop for the same gold.

Easier item reward window convenience

The window that hands out item rewards (from events, quests and shared duplicate loot) is quicker to use.

- It opens with nothing assigned, so you choose who gets each item instead of undoing the game's guess.
- Left-clicking another character moves an item to them in one click.
- Every item still has to go to someone before **Done**.

Reveal event outcomes shows hidden information

On town, road and boat events, hover over an option to see what it will do before you choose: the outcome story text, then its effects for your party (gold, damage, morale, items, an outpost attack, choices you'll be asked to make).

- When an outcome depends on a random roll, it shows the roll you would actually get.

Show personal quest rewards no gameplay change

When a new character picks one of two personal quests, each card shows the building that quest unlocks when the character retires, like the board game's quest cards do.

- It also shows what you'd get instead if someone unlocks that building first.
- If another party member's quest would unlock the same building, it says so: whoever retires second gets the other building.
- The extra quest you can draw with 15 inspiration when retiring shows it too.

Masteries carry over changes the game

Once a character earns a mastery, every later character of that class starts with that mastery already done, and gets its perk mark when created. No more re-doing the same awkward challenge for each new character of a class.

- Only masteries earned while this rule is on count.
- A carried mastery can't be earned a second time by the new character.
- Masteries are still only earned in scenarios you win, as usual.

Reduced randomness changes the game

Gloomhaven digital's house rule, which Frosthaven carries but never offers. Every attack modifier deck, yours and the monsters', swaps the null for a **-2** and the x2 for a **+2**. Both still reshuffle the deck at the end of the round. Curses become -2 and blesses +2. Fights get steadier: no wasted attacks, no huge spikes, for you or for them.

- Takes effect when the next scenario starts. It can't be changed during an online scenario.
- Perks work as usual. One that removes a -2 takes the plain -2 and leaves the reshuffling one, just as it leaves the null in the normal deck.

Dwarf's balance changes changes the game

A handful of changes from Dwarf74's *Unofficial Frosthaven Campaign Tweaks*. He maintains the official FAQ and was one of the main campaign playtesters. They smooth out spots many groups find frustrating:

- **Personal quests:** once everyone has finished one, the quests that unlock the Tavern and the Stables come up first, and new quests prefer ones that still unlock something new.
- **Early Barracks:** in the first winter, with good morale, the outpost event that upgrades the Barracks comes up early.
- **Shorter waits:** personal quest 7's two waits are 5 weeks instead of 6. Personal quest 15 needs 60 gold.
- **Scenario 14** is reworked: you also have to defeat the Abael Herders, and the spawning monsters alternate rounds.
- **Boneshaper:** the first mastery (kill 15 of your own summons) can be done across several scenarios.

More story events changes the game

More of your weekly town events move the story along: a new scenario, a section to read later, another event, a building, an item or a quest.

- When the week's event is drawn and none of its choices could unlock anything new, it goes to the bottom of the deck and the next one is drawn instead.
- Only once a week: the second card is kept, whatever it is, so quiet weeks still happen.
- Outpost attacks are never skipped.
- Roughly half of summer weeks and a quarter of winter weeks bring something new, instead of about a third and a seventh.

Game bug fixes changes the game

Fixes for mistakes in the game's own code. One switch for all of them:

- **Fair shuffles:** the game's shuffle is slightly broken, which makes nulls and x2s a little more common than they should be. Attack modifier decks, the loot deck and similar draws are shuffled properly.
- **Co-op:** fixes for several things that could put players out of sync or freeze the outpost.
- **Outpost:** rebuilding doesn't cost extra morale, morale can't go below 0, the Jeweler's discount is charged as shown, the calendar shows the right week, and a few events work the way their cards say (which buildings get attacked first, cards that went missing from the town guard deck).
- **Quests and events:** personal quest 14 needs five *different* areas, and the SO-10 delivery still arrives in later years.
- **Save list:** the Load window's preview shows each hero's current level and gold. Without the fix it showed what they had when they last went on a scenario (a party levelled in the outpost read as level 1).

Milestone saves no gameplay change

The game only keeps its last 15 autosaves, roughly the last hour or two of play. This makes a named backup at the start of every scenario and the moment the outpost opens after one (before the loot is handed out and the outpost events run), so you can go back further after a crash, a desync or a misclick.

- They appear in the normal **Load** list as *Mod backup - week 23 - scenario 14 start* or *Mod backup - week 23 - after scenario 14*.
- The newest 20 are kept. Your own saves and the game's autosaves are never touched.
- Only the host's game makes them. To go back in co-op, the host loads the backup on their own, then hosts the game again and everyone rejoins.
- Not available in Iron Man campaigns.

Battle stats no gameplay change

After each scenario, the **Statistics** tab gets about 40 extra rows: damage, kills, healing, shields, luck with your modifier deck, cards and elements used, exploration and more. Summons count for the character who summoned them.

- The **Campaign** button at the top of the Statistics page shows each character's totals over every scenario played with this on. **This scenario** switches back.
- Each finished scenario's full battle record is saved for the **Stats** tab of the companion app (charts of the whole party's campaign: luck, damage, rounds, trends). Wins, losses and resigns count; a restarted or unfinished scenario never does, and loading an older save takes back anything after it.

Modifier deck odds no gameplay change

In a scenario, right-click a character to open their info panel. Under Attack Modifiers (which shows how many of each card are left), it shows the odds of their next draw:

- Null, -1/-2, +0, +1 or more, x2, and the chance of a rolling bonus. Curses count as nulls and blesses as x2s (as -2 and +2 under Reduced randomness).
- Each modifier icon also has a small tag with that card's own chance.
- Right-click a monster to see the same for the monsters' deck.
- It notes when a deck will reshuffle at the end of the round. It's the same math you could do from the counts the game already shows.

Scenario map file no gameplay change

Saves your campaign's progress (which scenarios are done, available or locked out) every time the game autosaves, for the **scenario map page**.

- The map page shows every scenario, what unlocks it, what it leads to, and which ones lock each other out, coloured by your campaign's progress.
- It also shows the choices that still matter (like which of two scenarios to play) and how many scenarios each option keeps open, so you can aim for the most scenarios in one campaign.
- **Spoilers:** the map shows every scenario's name. Ask the host for the page if you want it.

Content packs

A content pack adds new things to the game rather than changing a rule. The mods carry one: the **Gloomhaven classes** pack, which adds all 17 classes from Gloomhaven and the four from Jaws of the Lion, each with their own cards, model, animations, effects, sounds and portraits, and the perks and masteries from Cephalofair's official Gloomhaven-in-Frosthaven sheets. You don't need Gloomhaven yourself: the installer brings everything.

- **Perks the sheets invented for Frosthaven** work as written, with two notes. The Sunkeeper's *Shielding Light* (an overflowing heal gives the ally Ward) and the Sawbones' *Revitalizing Medicine* (an ally using a Medical Pack first loses a negative condition; the worst one is removed for you) are the mods' own code. The Quartermaster's *Well Supplied* recovers up to four discarded cards once a scenario; the sheet also asks for a persistent Quartermaster card in your active area, which the mods don't check.
- **Masteries** that the game's own tracking can't express (the Scoundrel's kills next to allies, the Sunkeeper's Light every turn, the Sawbones' ally each turn and 20-damage attack, the Quartermaster's item every turn) are checked by the mods from the scenario's records. "Allies adjacent" counts characters, not summons.
- **One card plays differently:** the Quartermaster's *Catastrophic Bomb* (bottom) hits you and *all adjacent* normal enemies for 7, where Gloomhaven let you aim a small area: Frosthaven has no way to aim damage at an area. The Sawbones' Medical Packs never go in your hand; First Aid and the like hand them out.
- **Enhancing** works exactly as for Frosthaven's cards, at the Enhancer and its prices: each Gloomhaven dot became the mark a Frosthaven card has on that kind of ability (attacks and negative conditions a diamond, heals and positive conditions a diamond+, moves a circle, shields, retaliates, ranges, targets, pushes and pulls a square, areas a hex).
- **The second four** (Cragheart, Plagueherald, Nightshroud, Berserker) follow the same sheets. Their invented perks: the Cragheart's *Earthquakes* moves every enemy in a newly revealed room one hex (a controlled move, so it ends in an empty hex); the Plagueherald's *Xorn's Boon* is a once-a-scenario button in the activate bar; the Berserker's *Rapid Recovery* adds to the long-rest heal; the Nightshroud's *Empowering Night* is a once-a-scenario button used during her turn (the sheet says at the start of the scenario) that discards two cards and lets her pick and play a card with an active-bonus action from her pool. Two Nightshroud cards play a little differently: *Wings of the Night* (bottom) is a persistent toggle you switch on before an attack for its Move 2 (Frosthaven has no "before each attack" trigger), and her invisibility shows through the game's own effect. The Cragheart's obstacles are Frosthaven's rocks.
- **The other thirteen** (Spellweaver, Tinkerer, Mindthief, Summoner, Soothsinger, Doomstalker, Elementalist, Beast Tyrant and the Jaws of the Lion four) bring their Gloomhaven mechanics with them. Their summons use Gloomhaven's own models. Soothsinger *songs* and Mindthief *augments* stay in the active area as in Gloomhaven, and every figure a song reaches shows a music note on its status row. The Doomstalker's *dooms* show the Doomstalker icon on the doomed enemy. The Beast Tyrant's bear joins after the first round's card selection, as in Gloomhaven digital, and its cards say "Command:" where Gloomhaven has a banner. The Hatchet's Favorite shows as his axe icon on the marked enemy, and only the Hatchet can loot it back. A few things differ: the Tinkerer's mines are Frosthaven's ordinary traps, an "infuse any elements" card asks for one element at a time, and the Voidwarden's *Eye of the Void* (top) has the other enemies attack *a poisoned enemy* within range 3 (the target is always one) rather than the target itself, which Frosthaven's engine can't express.
- **To use it:** the host turns on **Gloomhaven classes (content pack)** in **Options > Custom Rules**, in the outpost. The Gloomhaven classes then show up when anyone creates a new character. The host's game makes a backup save (*Mod backup - before Gloomhaven classes*) the moment it's turned on.
- **How the classes arrive:** the classes wait in **envelopes**. Each retirement in the campaign opens one: the game offers two of the still-locked Gloomhaven classes and the party picks one, on the same screen it uses for its own class choices (with one class left, it simply unlocks). The four Jaws of the Lion classes (Demolitionist, Hatchet, Red Guard, Voidwarden) open the moment the switch is on. To have every class open at once, for testing or for a party that wants the whole roster, the host turns on **Gloomhaven classes: all open at once**, the switch under the pack's; turning it off again keeps the classes already open and the rest go back to waiting for retirements.

- **Retirement:** like every Frosthaven class, each ported class has its own retirement story, shown on the retirement screen. The reward is the class's own pair of events from Gloomhaven, an outpost event and a road event, some of which lead to further events (the Brute's caravan, the Sunkeeper's sun demons, the Sawbones' debts). Several Frosthaven classes are rewarded with events the same way. Their effects are Gloomhaven's, translated to Frosthaven's sizes (reputation becomes morale, a Gloomhaven scenario becomes a random side scenario), and each one is reviewed before it ships; until then an option tells its story with no effect. As with the game's own classes, the events come with the first character of that class to retire in a campaign.
- **Codex:** each Gloomhaven class has a hero page in the codex like the Frosthaven classes (Options > Codex > Heroes): portrait, description, health table, stats, traits, all its cards, and Gloomhaven digital's own role, difficulty and play notes. It is listed openly while every class is open from the start; a class that arrives in an envelope shows as "???" until a campaign has unlocked it, the way Frosthaven's later classes do.
- **Everyone needs the same version.** Unlike the other mods, the game checks this one: a player with a different pack is turned away when joining, with a message. A player without the mods at all only sees their join window reset, so if that happens, have them run the installer.
- **It can't be turned off once used.** As soon as someone has created a Gloomhaven character, the switch locks on. From then on that campaign must only be opened with the mods installed; without them, the game won't load it.
- **The way out, if the pack ever has to go: Copy without content packs**. In the outpost it is in **Save Game** (host only); in the main menu it appears in **Load game** on any campaign that carries pack content, even one the game can no longer open because its pack is gone. It needs the mods installed, not the pack. It saves a new campaign, *<your campaign> (no content packs)*, that loads in a game without the pack or without the mods at all: no Gloomhaven characters (their items go back to the shop, their gold and resources are lost), none of the pack's unlocks, enhancements, retirement stories or events, and only the game's own house rules. Your real campaign is not touched. The copy is checked twice before it is offered, and the button refuses rather than writing a copy that might not load. Loading a save whose pack is missing is also stopped with the same offer, instead of failing inside the game (which would move the save to its corrupted folder).
- **Try it on a test campaign first.** Until we've played it together, keep it out of your main campaign.
- **Looks and sounds:** his model, animations (roars included), sounds and ability effects (the shout rings, the earthquake wave, his heal and power-up glows) come from Gloomhaven, the effects redrawn with Frosthaven's own effect shaders; hits, footsteps and weapon trails are Frosthaven's. His alternative look from Gloomhaven, *Boneguard*, is picked per character with the **Skin** button under his name on his character sheet (the player who controls him picks; everyone sees it). His cards look like Frosthaven's own (banner, framed halves in his blue, the initiative hex, icons with numbers), but every card shares one banner picture of him, as Gloomhaven's cards never had paintings.

If something goes wrong

- **"Out of sync" / desync message:** before closing the game, everyone presses <kbd>Ctrl</kbd>+<kbd>F7</kbd>. It puts a zip file on your desktop. Send it to Kalarian along with what you were doing.
- **Something got lost or went badly:** the host can load a **Mod backup** save (see Milestone saves).
- **Not sure everyone is on the same version:** everyone runs the installer again. It shows the version it installed.

Frosthaven Mods is a fan project, not made or supported by Snapshot Games or Cephalofair.